# TOP 20 HTML & CSS INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Beginner-friendly interview preparation notes for freshers

## How to use these notes

Read each question, understand the key points, and practise explaining the answer in your own words. For technical interviews, be ready to write a small code example and explain what it does.

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# PART 1: HTML – TOP 10 QUESTIONS

### *1. What is HTML?*

HTML stands for HyperText Markup Language. It is used to create the structure and content of web pages.

```
<!DOCTYPE html> <html> <head> <title>My First Page</title> </head> <body> <h1>Hello World</h1>
<p>Welcome to HTML</p> </body> </html>
```

### *2. What is the difference between HTML and HTML5?*

HTML5 is the modern major version of HTML. It introduced semantic elements such as header, nav, section and footer, along with native audio, video, canvas and other web features.

### *3. What are HTML tags and elements?*

A tag is the markup written inside angle brackets, such as . An element is the complete structure, usually including an opening tag, content and closing tag. Example: Hello Students . Some elements, such as img and br, are void elements and do not have closing tags.

### *4. What is the difference between block-level and inline elements?*

Block-level elements normally start on a new line and take the available width by default (for example, div, p and h1). Inline elements flow within a line and take only the space they need (for example, span, a and strong).

### *5. What are semantic HTML elements?*

Semantic elements describe the meaning or role of their content. Examples: header (introductory content), nav (navigation), main (main page content), section (thematic section), article (independent content) and footer (footer information).

### *6. What is the difference between id and class?*

An id identifies one unique element on a page and is selected in CSS with #, for example #header. A class can be reused on multiple elements and is selected with ., for example .heading.

### *7. What is the difference between div and span?*

div is a generic block-level container, while span is a generic inline container. Both are used to group content so it can be styled or targeted with scripts.

### *8. What is the purpose of the DOCTYPE declaration?*

The declaration <!DOCTYPE html> tells the browser to use standards mode for the HTML document. It is placed at the very beginning of an HTML page.

### *9. What is the difference between GET and POST in HTML forms?*

GET sends form data as URL parameters and is commonly used to retrieve data. POST sends data in the request body and is commonly used to submit data. POST does not itself encrypt information; use HTTPS to protect data in transit.

### *10. What is the difference between HTML and XHTML?*

XHTML applies stricter XML-style syntax rules to HTML. For example, elements must be properly nested, tag names are lowercase, and elements must be closed. HTML is more forgiving of common markup mistakes.

# PART 2: CSS – TOP 10 QUESTIONS

### *11. What is CSS?*

CSS stands for Cascading Style Sheets. It controls the presentation of HTML pages, including colours, fonts, spacing, layouts and responsive behaviour.

```
h1 { color: blue; font-size: 30px; }
```

### *12. What are the three ways to apply CSS?*

Inline CSS is written in an element's style attribute. Internal CSS is written inside a style element in the HTML head. External CSS is written in a separate .css file and linked to the HTML page. External CSS is commonly preferred for maintainability and reuse.

### *13. What is the difference between an id selector and a class selector in CSS?*

An id selector uses #, for example #heading { color: red; }. A class selector uses ., for example .title { color: blue; }. An id should be unique on the page; a class can be shared by many elements.

### *14. What is the CSS box model?*

The CSS box model describes how an element's size is made up of content, padding, border and margin. Content is the inner area; padding is space around the content; border surrounds the padding; margin is space outside the border.

### *15. What is the difference between margin and padding?*

Margin is the space outside an element's border. Padding is the space between the content and the element's border.

### *16. What is the difference between display: none and visibility: hidden?*

Both hide an element. display: none removes it from the page layout, so its space is not reserved. visibility: hidden makes it invisible but keeps its layout space.

### *17. What are the CSS position values?*

static is the default position. relative moves an element relative to its normal position. absolute positions it relative to its nearest positioned ancestor. fixed positions it relative to the viewport. sticky behaves like normal flow until its scroll threshold is reached, then sticks within its containing area.

### *18. What is the difference between Flexbox and Grid?*

Flexbox is mainly a one-dimensional layout system for arranging items in a row or a column. CSS Grid is a two-dimensional layout system that handles rows and columns together. Both can be used to build responsive layouts.

### *19. What are pseudo-classes and pseudo-elements?*

A pseudo-class selects an element in a particular state, such as button:hover. A pseudo-element styles a specific part of an element, such as p::first-letter.

```
button:hover { background-color: blue; } p::first-letter { color: red; font-size: 30px; }
```

### *20. What is responsive web design?*

Responsive web design means creating pages that adapt to different screen sizes, such as phones, tablets and desktops. Common techniques include flexible layouts, relative units, Flexbox, Grid and media queries.

```
@media (max-width: 600px) { body { background-color: lightblue; } }
```

# BONUS: PRACTICAL INTERVIEW EXERCISES

Ask students to complete these tasks without copying a ready-made solution. Encourage them to explain their approach.

## HTML practical tasks

1. Create a student registration form using HTML.
2. Create a table containing five students and their marks.
3. Create an ordered list and an unordered list.
4. Create a webpage containing images and hyperlinks.
5. Create a webpage using header, nav, main, section and footer.

## CSS practical tasks

1. Design a login page using CSS.
2. Create a navigation bar using Flexbox.
3. Create a card layout using CSS Grid.
4. Apply hover effects to buttons and links.
5. Make a webpage responsive using media queries.

**Trainer's tip:** Ask every student to explain each answer in their own words and write at least one small code example. Understanding the concept is more useful than memorising the definition.